

ALMILA BASAK

CONTACT INFORMATION	Department of Political Science Maxwell School of Citizenship and Public Affairs Syracuse University 024 Eggers Hall, Syracuse, New York 13244	@ abasak@syr.edu ☎ 315.560.8204
EDUCATION	Doctor of Philosophy — Political Science Syracuse University	2021 – 2027 (Expected)
	- Fields: Comparative Politics (Major), Law and Courts (Minor) - Dissertation: <i>Varieties of Right-Wing Populism Beyond Welfare Chauvinism</i> - Committee: Seth K Jolly (Chair), Margarita Estevez-Abe, Jessie Trudeau	
	Master of Arts — Political Science Syracuse University	2021 – 2023
	Bachelor of Science - Political Science and Public Administration Middle East Technical University, Turkey Minor: Economics	2014 – 2019
ACADEMIC AFFILIATIONS	Graduate Research Associate Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs, Center for European Studies, Syracuse University	2024 – Present
	Graduate Research Associate Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs, Middle Eastern Studies Program, Syracuse University	2023 – Present
	Teaching Associate Future Professoriate Program, Syracuse University	2023 – 2026

Research

RESEARCH INTERESTS	Subfields: Political Parties, Populism, Comparative Political Economy, Politics of Social Policy, European Politics, Turkish Politics	
RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS	Graduate Research Assistant, Dr. Jessie Trudeau .	Spring 2026
	Graduate Research Assistant, Dr. Jessie Trudeau .	Spring 2025
	Graduate Research Assistant, Dr. Jessie Trudeau .	2023-2024
	Global Free Speech Repository Research Assistant, Dr. Thomas Keck.	2022 – 2023
CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS	[6] "Welfare Promises of Right-Wing Populist Parties:Whom to Attract and How to Allocate?"	April 2026

- presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference.
- [5] "The electoral returns to vote buying: Evidence from Brazil" April 2026
presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference
with Dr. Jessie Trudeau.
- [4] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers?
Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence" May 2025
presented at the European Union Studies Association Conference
with Prof Seth Jolly.
- [3] "Welfare State Policies: Window for Party Politics?," September 2024
presented at the American Political Science Association Conference.
- [2] "Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP," November 2022
presented at the Northeastern Political Science Association.
- [1] "Understanding the Unnatural Voting: The Case of AKP," September 2022
presented at the Political Science Research Workshop at
Syracuse University.

SKILLS **Statistics Software:** R, R Studio, ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, GitHub, MAXQDA
Document Preparation Systems: L^AT_EX, R Markdown, Microsoft Office Suite

- WORKING PAPERS**
- [3] "Welfare Promises of Populist Right Parties: Whom to Attract and How to Allocate?"
- [2] "The Electoral Returns to Bending Campaign Rules: Evidence from Brazil" (with Dr. Trudeau)
- [1] "Dissatisfied Voters or Alienated Abstainers? Abstention and Voter-Parliament Incongruence" (with Dr. Jolly)

Teaching

TEACHING ASSISTANT **PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics,**
Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe Fall 2025
Role: Section Leader

PSC 123 Comparative Government and Politics,
Prof Margarita Estevez-Abe Fall 2024
Role: Section Leader

INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD **PSC 388 Globalization and the Rise of Populism** May 2024

Grants, Awards, and Honors

GRANTS **Summer Dissertation Fellowship**
Syracuse University Graduate School April 2026

Research Assistantship Fellowship
Syracuse University Political Science Department Spring 2026

Roscoe Martin Fund for Dissertation and Thesis Research

	<i>Syracuse University Maxwell School</i>	2025
	Goekjian/Center for European Studies Research Grant <i>Moynihan Institute of Global Affairs</i>	2025
	Research Assistantship Fellowship <i>Syracuse University Political Science Department</i>	Spring 2025
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization</i>	2024
	Professional, Academic and Creative Work Travel Grant <i>Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization</i>	2023
	Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2022-23
	Fulbright PhD Scholarship	2021-22
AWARDS	Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award <i>Syracuse University Graduate School</i>	2026
	Koff Award <i>The best graduate student paper written each year on comparative politics</i> <i>Syracuse University Political Science Department</i>	2025
	Young Scholar Prize <i>For the paper” Social Policy and the Gender Gap in Party Preferences: The Case of the AKP era in Turkey”</i> <i>Syracuse University Middle East Studies Program</i>	2023
HONORS	Graduated as first-ranked student of the Middle East Technical University’s Political Science Department	June 2019
	Graduated as third-ranked student of the Middle East Technical University	June 2019

Service

TO THE INSTITUTION	Co-President , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2023-2024
	Pre-Comprehensive Exams Student Representative , Political Science Graduate Student Association.	2022-2023
	Political Science Department Representative , Syracuse University Graduate Student Organization, Graduate Pandemic Committee member	2021-2022
TO THE DISCIPLINE	Panelist , <i>Independent Teaching as a Graduate Student</i> organized by Future Professoriate Program	October 2025
	Organizer , <i>Geocoding Workshop with Dr Trudeau</i> for Political Science Graduate Students.	October 2024

Co-organizer, *Future Professoriate Program seminar:*
"Predocs, Postdocs, and Fellowships: What You Need to Know"
at Political Science Research Workshop, Syracuse University.

December 2023

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	European Political Science Society	2026 – Present
	Midwest Political Science Association	2026 – Present
	European Union Studies Association	2025 – Present
	American Political Science Association	2024 – Present

Updated April 24, 2026